SURABHI MITRA, *31*
Psychiatrist (left)

PAROMITA MUKHERJEE, *27*
Operations executive

Paromita is from Kolkata and Surabhi from Nagpur, where the couple is currently based. They live with Surabhi's father, Kajal

'MY PARENTS WERE WORRIED'

When Surabhi and Paromita exchanged rings during their engagement in Nagpur in December 2021, the only family member in attendance was Surabhi's father. His support came after much concern about the impact it would have on his daughter's career. "My father was worried that people would point fingers and say that the psychiatrist they believed in so much has a mental disorder herself. He was worried that they would try to defame me," recalls Surabhi.

While their families have now accepted the relationship, they were concerned about the duo going public with it. For Paromita's parents, it's important that same-sex marriages have legal sanction whenever the two decide to tie the knot. "Only if same-sex marriage is legalised will they agree that it is a marriage," says Surabhi.

In April, Surabhi and Paromita joined INFOSEM and two other Mumbai-based couples to seek marriage equality.

"Homosexuality is not a disease. Homophobia is. But it has a cure: proper education, knowledge and awareness"

– SURABHI MITRA



MANDAR DEODHAR

VIEWPOINT

ABHISHEK MANU SINGHVI

Senior jurist and Congress Rajya Sabha member, appearing for the petitioners



"The current interpretation of the Special Marriage Act, 1954, denies same-sex couples rights because of sexual orientation, an ascriptive characteristic over which they have no control. We are not asking the court to strike down the law but to interpret it in a way that is non-discriminatory"

KAPIL SIBAL

Former Union minister and lawyer, opposing same-sex marriage in court



"The marriage of heterosexual couples has the acceptance on all three levels—by individuals, family and society. If you want to equate same-sex unions to heterosexual ones, you need all the elements that go into heterosexual unions being recognised"